Punjab had started collaborating with them to carry out activities within Pakistan (*Rediff News*, 2009).

It struck repeatedly in Islamabad, Lahore and Peshawar. The shrines of revered Sufi saints were targeted in Peshawar, Swat and as far as in Lahore, Punjab and Karachi. The twin suicide attack on the shrine of Data Ganj Bakhsh, known as Data Darbar (the court of the giver) resulted in 40 deaths and 175 injuries in 2010. In the same year, low-intensity bomb blasts were detonated at the shrines of Peer Khaki Shah at Bagrial Chowk, Green Town, and on 3 June 2010, two low-intensity bomb explosions occurred at Duri Buri Darbarat Lahore (Shah, 2015).

In Karachi, nine people, including two children, were killed and more than 65 others sustained injuries when two suicide bombers blew themselves up at the shrine of Abdullah Shah Ghazi in the Clifton area, Karachi, in October 2010. These incidents at the places greatly revered by followers of all schools of thought horrified people all over the country (*The News International*, 2010).

After two days, the shrine of Mian Karim Baba at Swabi (KP) was blown up by detonating an IED planted close to it. Some of the details related to the incidents of bombing the shrines and *madaris* in KP are provided in Tables 5.1 and 5.2.

These activities demonstrated the terrorists' strong sectarian animosity and intolerance towards other sects like Barelvis and Shi'as. It gave a new dimension to the terrorist strategy, which helped them diversify their activities resulting in confusing the government and attracting different religious extremist groups in their fold or at least developed sympathy for them.

Most of the terrorist attacks carried out by the TTP in urban centres, especially in Punjab are sectarian in nature. This cunning move not only attracted the ultra-violent activists of LeJ towards the TTP, but has also created an ever-widening wedge between Barelvis and Deobandis and between Shi'as and Sunnis, causing widespread unrest and mistrust in the society.

Suicide terrorism

When a suicide bomber attacked the Egyptian Embassy in Islamabad in 1996, most people in Pakistan concluded that the perpetrator was not a Muslim as suicide is forbidden in Islam. However, there are some sects of Islam which believe that self-sacrifice, may be in the form of suicide attacks,